

Sample Basic Safeguarding Policy ("this Policy")

Details	
Date approved	
Date of last review	
Next review date	

[Our organisation] is fully committed to safeguarding the welfare and wellbeing of all children and adults in our care. We recognise our responsibility to promote safe practice and to protect everyone from harassment, abuse, and exploitation.

This Policy outlines our commitment to protecting children and vulnerable adults.

1. Policy review schedule

- 1.1 This Policy will be reviewed after 1 year initially and then at least every 2 years by the Board, or:
- when there are changes in relevant legislation
 - when there are changes in guidance on safeguarding children or adults
 - following any issues or concerns relating to safeguarding within [our organisation], whichever is the sooner.

2. Responsibilities

- 2.1. The responsibility for updating and gaining approval of this Policy is assigned to the Safeguarding Lead.
- 2.2. The responsibility for ensuring compliance with this Policy rests with the Board and Senior Management.

3. Purpose of this Policy

The purpose of this Policy is to:

- 3.1. Ensure that the welfare of children and vulnerable adults remains the paramount consideration in all aspects of the work across [our organisation].
- 3.2. Ensure all Personnel understand how to implement good safeguarding practice in their role.
- 3.3. Ensure everyone connected with [our organisation] knows how to respond appropriately when a concern arises.
- 3.4. Provide clarity around the process and procedures that will be followed when this Policy, or associated codes, rules, or regulations are breached.

4. Scope of this Policy



- 4.1. This Policy applies to everyone who is bound by [our organisation's] policies, i.e. anyone acting on behalf of [our organisation] in any capacity including (and not limited to), employees, consultants, contractors, volunteers, athletes, and Board Members.

5. Legal and organisational policy context

- 5.1. This Policy has been developed with due regard to the following law and guidance:
- The United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child
 - The Universal Declaration of Human Rights
 - National Child Protection Legislation
 - National Adult Protection Legislation.

6. Principles

- 6.1. We will always take care to do no harm, or where harm has already occurred, make sure that any actions taken do not increase the extent of the harm.
- 6.2. The welfare and best interests of the child or vulnerable adult will be the paramount consideration in everything we do.
- 6.3. We will be survivor-centred in everything we do.
- 6.4. Everyone has an equal right to protection from harm regardless of their gender, culture, ethnicity, age, religion, sexual orientation, or ability.
- 6.5. Children have a right to have their voices heard and their views will genuinely shape and influence how we work.

7. Definitions

- 7.1. **Child:** Anyone under the age of 18 years old.
- 7.2. **Vulnerable adult:** Anyone 18 years or over who is, or may be, unable to take care of themselves against abuse, or exploitation, whether due to age, physical or mental disability, or current situation.
- 7.3. **Safeguarding:** Safeguarding refers to all the policies, procedures, and actions that an organisation delivers, to minimise the risk of abuse and respond appropriately to concerns when they arise.
- 7.4. **Child protection:** Refers to the actions we take when we have specific concerns that a particular child is at risk of significant harm.
- 7.5. **Harm:** Refers to the damage caused by violence, abuse, harassment, and neglect, and includes emotional, physical, and sexual harm.
- 7.6. **Personnel:** Anyone acting on behalf of an organisation in any capacity including (and not limited to), employees, consultants, contractors, volunteers, athletes, entourage, commission or committee members and Board Members.

8. [Our Organisation] will

- 8.1. Promote the health and wellbeing of children and adults, by providing opportunities for them to take part in sport safely.

- 8.2. Respect and promote the rights, wishes and feelings of children and adults.
- 8.3. Promote and implement appropriate procedures to safeguard the wellbeing of children and adults and protect them from abuse.
- 8.4. Respond to all reports and concerns related to safeguarding issues and/or poor practice.
- 8.5. Require all Personnel to adopt and abide by this Policy and accompanying procedures.
- 8.6. Respond to any allegations of misconduct or abuse of children or adults, in line with this Policy as well as implementing, where appropriate, the relevant disciplinary and appeals procedures.
- 8.7. Observe national published guidance for the protection and wellbeing of children.
- 8.8. Regularly monitor and evaluate the implementation of this Policy and these procedures.

9. Policy Statements

- 9.1. Anyone working on behalf of [our organisation] is required to sign and comply with [our organisation's] code(s) of conduct.
- 9.2. Anyone working on behalf of [our organisation] is required to undertake safeguarding risk assessments, and mitigate any risks identified, before an activity takes place.
- 9.3. Everyone has a responsibility to respond when they are concerned that a child may be at risk of harm – all concerns must be reported.
- 9.4. Anyone that reports a concern in good faith will be protected under [our organisation's] Proactive Reporting policy.
- 9.5. Safeguarding concerns will be managed through a sensitive, robust, and transparent process. The Safeguarding Lead will manage all such concerns in co-ordination with law enforcement agencies where appropriate.
- 9.6. Information will be managed confidentially and only shared without their consent where the duty to protect people from harm supersedes an individual's right to privacy, keeping in mind their best interests at all times.
- 9.7. Safeguarding decisions will be made in a timely manner and should not be subject to unnecessary delay.
- 9.8. Care and support will be made available to victims and survivors.
- 9.9. Anyone working on behalf of [our organisation] will be subject to the most robust safeguarding recruitment checks for which they are eligible.
- 9.10. Everyone working on behalf of [our organisation] will receive safeguarding training, support, and supervision appropriate to their role and responsibilities.
- 9.11. Serious breaches of this Policy or associated codes, rules, or regulations may result in formal disciplinary action being taken.
- 9.12. All organisations engaged in a formal partnership with [our organisation] are expected to comply with the requirements of this Policy.
- 9.13. Progress towards meeting all the above requirements will be monitored by the Safeguarding Lead and reported to the Board quarterly.



INTERNATIONAL SAFEGUARDS
FOR CHILDREN IN SPORT

Adopted by:
Signature of Board Chair

Date: